TEN IDEOLOGICAL STANDPOINTS IN RELATION TO THE BRICS

1. *BRICS from above* – heads of state, corporates and elite allies
   - 1.1 BRICS as *anti*-imperialist: foreign ministry *rhetoric* – 'Talk Left, Walk Right' – based upon national-liberation traditions, with some concrete actions (such as opposition to Intellectual Property applied to medicines, especially for AIDS, safe haven for US spy whistleblower Edward Snowden, and hostility to the proposed US bombing of Syria in 2013)
   - 1.2 BRICS as *sub*-imperialist: relegitimisation of 'globalisation', lubricating neoliberalism in – and exploiting – BRICS hinterlands, intensifying structural exploitation of the poor / workers / women / nature on behalf of global / local capital, ensuring maximum greenhouse gas emissions alongside BASIC / US no matter the local / continental / global consequences, and even sometimes playing a 'deputy sheriff' role to world hegemons
   - 1.3 BRICS as *inter*-imperialist: potential new internet delinked from the US; promotion of Putin v Obama in September 2013 at G20; and backing Russia in Crimea/Ukraine conflict

2. Brics from the middle – BRICS Academic Forum, intellectuals, trade unions, NGOs
   - 2.1 *pro-BRICS advocates*: most of Academic Forum, most establishment 'think tanks', the 'Civic BRICS' initiated by Russia, and others (including leftists) claiming BRICS will increasingly challenge global injustices
   - 2.2 *wait-and-see about BRICS:* most NGOs and their funders – as well as most 'Third Worldist' intellectuals – who wish for BRICS to become 'anti-impi' in the UN and Bretton Woods Institutions, using the New Development Bank and Contingent Reserve Arrangement, etc.
   - 2.3 *critics of BRICS:* those associated with BRICS-from-below networks who consider BRICS to be 'sub-impis' and sometimes also 'inter-impis'